

STRATEGIC DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE REPORT (2026)

Myanmar Arms Dynamics, Territorial Power & EAO-SAC Strategic Relationships

An Operations Research Synthesis of Battlefield Telemetry, Domestic Manufacturing, Force Balances, and Sovereign Fragmentation

EVIDENTIARY HORIZON	TERRITORIAL STATUS	FORCE ASYMMETRY	STRATEGIC POSTURE
Multi-INT Fusion: 2021–Q4 2026 battlefield observation. Integrates verified OSINT, NATO 6x6 Admiralty assessments, satellite thermal telemetry (NASA FIRMS), and flight radar sorties.	State Collapse: The military junta (SAC) controls only 21%–33% of national landmass, isolated strictly to central urban fortified enclaves. Resistance/EAOs govern 48.5% of territory.	Drone & Air Denial: SAC air dominance neutralized below 3,800m by FN-6/HN-5 MANPADS. Resistance forces lead an asymmetric drone revolution with 25,000+ synchronized FPV/hexacopter sorties.	Polycentric Governance: A 4-tier posture taxonomy classifies EAOs from total offensive eradication (3BA, K7) to armed neutrality (UWSA), fractured ceasefires, and proxy militias.

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PILLAR 2: SPATIAL TELEMETRY & SOVEREIGN LANDMASS

Slide 2: National Macro Sovereign Allocation (2026 Landscape)

SOVEREIGNTY CATEGORY	LANDMASS ALLOCATION	OPERATIONAL GOVERNANCE & CONTROLLED ASSETS
Resistance & EAO Controlled	48.5% (Range: 42% – 55%)	Continuous liberated peripheral mountain belts, international border crossings with China, Thailand, and India, and lucrative jade/rare-earth/gemstone extractive corridors.
Actively Contested Frontlines	26.5% (Range: 20% – 37%)	Shifting rural-to-urban transition zones, interdicted highways (Asian Highway 1), active artillery/bombardment corridors, and dynamic PDF-junta skirmish sectors in Sagaing/Magway.
SAC Junta Administrative Core	25.0% (Range: 21% – 33%)	Strictly confined to heavily fortified garrison enclaves: Naypyidaw administrative fortress, Yangon commercial port, Mandalay city core, and fortified riverine naval stations.

Strategic Fragmentation: The SAC has lost the ability to execute nationwide administrative governance. The military operates not as a sovereign government, but as a heavily besieged urban garrison army reliant on punitive standoff aerial bombardments.

Logistical Severance: Over 80% of overland arterial highways connecting the central plains to frontier borders are severed by resistance checkpoints. Ground supply columns require multi-battalion armored escorts that frequently succumb to ambushes.

PILLAR 2: REGIONAL CONTROL ANALYTICS

Slide 3: State-by-State Territorial Dominance Matrix (2026)

FACTION / COALITION	THEATER / STATE	DOMINANCE	KEY LIBERATED TOWNSHIPS & ASSETS	SAC REMNANT GARRISONS
Arakan Army (AA)	Rakhine & Paletwa	92.6%	Paletwa, Kyauktaw, Mrauk-U, Minbya, Ponnagyun, Buthidaung, Maungdaw, Thandwe	Sittwe capital & Kyaukphyu deep-sea port perimeter
United Wa State Army (UWSA)	Wa Special Region 2	95.0%–100%	Panghsang, Mong Pawk, Hopang, Panlong, Military Region 171	Zero junta presence; complete de facto statehood
KNDF / KNPP / IEC	Kayah (Karenni) State	85.0%	Demoso, Bawlake, Hpasawng, Mese border gate, Mawchi tungsten mines	Loikaw Regional Operations Command hilltop
Chinland Council / CB	Chin State	82.5%	Mindat, Kanpetlet, Matupi, Tedim, Rihkhawdar border crossing	Portions of Hakha & Falam hilltops under siege
Kachin Independence Army (KIA)	Kachin & N. Shan	75.0%	Lweje China border port, Pangwa & Sadung rare earths, Sumprabum, Laiza	Myitkyina capital & Bhamo airport perimeter
Three Brotherhood (MNDAA/TNLA)	Northern Shan State	75.0%	Laukkai, Chinshwehaw, Kunlong, Kyaukme, Hsipaw, Mogok ruby valley	Contested outskirts of Naungcho & Lashio buffer
KNU / KNLA Brigades 1–7	Kayin State & Tanintharyi	65.0%	Kawthoolei administrative districts, Asian Highway 1 interdiction	Hpa-an capital & fortified highway bases
People's Defence Forces (NUG)	Central Dry Zone	55.0% (Rural)	Depayin, Tabayin, Gangaw, Pauk, Chaung-U rural valleys (Pa-Ah-Ya)	Urban cores (Monywa, Sagaing, Mandalay)

PILLAR 2: GEO-ECONOMIC TELEMETRY

Slide 4: Strategic Border Corridors & Natural Resource Basins

GEOPOLITICAL CHOKEPOINT	CONTROLLING ACTOR	ECONOMIC & MILITARY SIGNIFICANCE
Chinshwehaw & Laukkai Gate (China)	MNDAA (Kokang Special Region)	Primary overland bilateral trade gateway; generates massive customs revenue; completely severed from Naypyidaw treasury.
Pangwa & Sadung Basins (China)	Kachin Independence Army (KIA)	Global hub of heavy rare-earth extraction (dysprosium/terbium); provides crucial leverage over regional clean-tech manufacturing.
Myawaddy / Mae Sot Corridor (Thailand)	KNU / KNLA (Asian Highway 1)	Historically routed >70% of overland border commerce with Thailand; SAC customs authority extinguished; approach roads interdicted.
Mogok Gemstone Valley (Mandalay/Shan)	Ta'ang National Liberation Army (TNLA)	Historic 'Valley of Rubies'; world-class sapphire and ruby mines seized during Operation 1027 Phase 2; junta completely evicted.
Hpakant Jade Quarry Corridor (Kachin)	Kachin Independence Army (KIA)	Multi-billion dollar jadeite extractive basin; provides independent fiscal self-sufficiency for KIA multi-brigade standing forces.

Fiscal Inversion: The loss of border gates and resource extraction nodes has depleted the SAC of foreign currency reserves. Simultaneously, EAO administrations have established institutional customs and taxation bureaus, transforming insurgent movements into fully funded state-like governance entities.

PILLAR 1: COMPARATIVE DEFENSE INDUSTRIES

Slide 5: Domestic Manufacturing: SAC KaPaSa vs. EAO Armories

ARMAMENT BUREAU	FACILITIES & BASE	CORE PRODUCTION LINES & CALIBERS	SUPPLY CHAIN VULNERABILITIES
SAC KaPaSa (DDI) Directorate of Defence Industries	25 heavy factories along Irrawaddy corridor (Magway, Bago, Mandalay)	- MA-1/2/3/4 (5.56x45mm NATO) - MA-15 GPMG (7.62x51mm NATO) - MAM-01/02 MLRS (122mm/240mm) - FAB-500 & ODAB-500 thermobaric bombs	Critical dependence on imported CNC spares, alloy steels, and chemical precursors via Singapore/China maritime routes.
KIO Technical Dept Kachin Independence Organization	3 armories in Laiza and Mai Ja Yang frontier	- K-09 / K-10 rifles (7.62x39mm Soviet) 60mm & 81mm cast-iron mortar shells - Directional bounding fragmentation mines	Smuggled bar-stock steel and explosive chemical precursors sourced across China border crossings.
UWSA Armament Bureau Wa Special Region 2	4 industrial facilities in Panghsang & Mong Pawk	- Type 81-Wa assault rifles (7.62x39mm) 7.62x39mm & 12.7x108mm ammunition stamping 120mm heavy siege mortar systems	Heavy industrial reliance on cross-border Chinese component and raw metal trade pipelines.
Decentralized PDF Cells Anti-Coup Resistance Clandestine	Hundreds of mobile distributed jungle workshops	- FGC-9 Mk II carbines (9x19mm Parabellum) - Electrochemical machined (ECM) rifled barrels - Modular 3D-printed drone drop release hooks	Vulnerable to localized raw filament shortages, lithium-polymer drone battery seizures, and junta power blackouts.

PILLAR 1: KINETIC INDIRECT FIREPOWER

Slide 6: Comparative Artillery, MLRS & Siege Systems

SYSTEM DOMAIN	SAC MILITARY JUNTA ARSENAL	RESISTANCE & EAO ARSENAL	OPERATIONAL ASYMMETRY & OUTCOME
Infantry Mortars	MA-6 (60mm), MA-8 (81mm), MA-9 (120mm heavy mortars). Standard factory ammunition.	KIO 60/81mm, UWSA 120mm siege mortars, improvised drone-dropped mortar bombs.	EAOs achieve superior tactical flexibility through drone-spotted rapid shoot-and-scoot mortar deployments.
Field Tube Artillery	122mm D-30 Howitzers, 105mm OTO Melara, 155mm Soltam heavy guns. Static firebases.	Captured 122mm D-30 batteries (captured en masse during Op 1027), improvised siege mortars.	SAC retains maximum firing range (>15km) but suffers fatal garrison isolation and high ammunition burn rates under siege.
Multiple Launch Rockets (MLRS)	MAM-01 (122mm 40-tube truck-mounted), MAM-02 (240mm heavy saturation rockets).	Type 90 (122mm MLRS - UWSA/MNDAA), 107mm Type 63 single-tube standoff rockets.	SAC uses unguided MLRS for broad area terror; resistance utilizes 107mm rockets for precision standoff strikes on airbases.
Anti-Armor & Bunker Defenses	RPG-7, Carl Gustaf 84mm, Type 69 RPG, heavily fortified concrete bunker pillboxes.	RPG-7, RPG-2, FPV Kamikaze Drones with shaped-charge PG-7V warheads.	Resistance FPV drones dive directly into pillbox firing slits, neutralizing fortified positions without requiring frontal assaults.

PILLAR 1: AERIAL WARFARE DYNAMICS

Slide 7: Air Superiority vs. Asymmetric Air Denial Mesh

SAC AERIAL CAPABILITY	EAO ASYMMETRIC AIR DENIAL MESH
Advanced Strike Fighters: - Sukhoi Su-30SME (Mach 2.0, AL-31FP turbofans, ODAB-500 thermobaric bombs) - Mikoyan MiG-29B/SE (Mach 2.25, RD-33 engines, FAB-500 demolition bombs) Light Attack & CAS Workhorses: - Yak-130 & K-8W (1.2–8.0 kHz compressor whine, S-8 rockets, 23mm gun pods) - Mi-35P Hind Gunships (18.5–23.0 Hz rotor slap, twin 30mm autocannon) - Y-12 Transport Bombers (High-altitude unguided barrel-bomb gravity drops) Operational Doctrine: Due to ground logistical paralysis, SAC relies exclusively on 15–30 daily air sorties to terrorize civilian settlements and relieve besieged outposts.	Multi-Tiered Air Defense Assets: FN-6 & HN-5 MANPADS: Passive infrared homing missiles brokered via UWSA; operational ceiling ~3,800m. Forces SAC jets to inaccurate high-altitude bombing. Mobile Heavy AAA: Truck-mounted 14.5mm ZPU-4 and 12.7mm DShK anti-aircraft technicals providing lethal low-altitude perimeter defense. Acoustic Doppler Early Warning: Parla edge acoustic sensors detecting turbofan harmonics, providing 4–8 minute shelter alert windows. Kinetic Attrition Telemetry (2021–2026): Over 50+ confirmed SAC military airframes downed or destroyed by MANPADS, anti-aircraft fire, and runway drone strikes (including FTC-2000G, K-8W, Mi-17, Mi-35P, and CH-4 UAVs).

PILLAR 1: ASYMMETRIC DRONE TELEMETRY

Slide 8: The Tactical Drone Warfare Revolution

DRONE OPERATIONAL DOMAIN	TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS & TACTICAL APPLICATION	BATTLEFIELD IMPACT & STRATEGIC SHIFT
Agricultural Hexacopter Bombers	Custom heavy-lift carbon-fiber frames (e.g. modified DJI Agras platforms) carrying 2 to 6 mortar bombs (60mm/81mm) or shaped demolition blocks with 3D-printed release servos.	Replaces conventional field artillery; provides precision vertical dive-bombing on junta ammunition depots, barracks, and communication masts.
FPV Kamikaze Strike Drones	First-Person-View high-speed racing drones equipped with analog 5.8 GHz video links, signal-hopping 915 MHz ELRS control, and PG-7V shaped-charge anti-tank warheads.	Complete neutralization of SAC light armored combat vehicles (BTR-3U, EE-9 Cascavel) and surgical strikes into bunker ventilation slits.
Operation 1027 Saturation Sorties	Coordinated multi-drone swarm strikes deployed by the Three Brotherhood Alliance (AA, MNDAA, TNLA) exceeding 25,000 synchronized combat drops.	Paralyzed the SAC Northeast Regional Military Command (Lashio) artillery battalions, creating safe assault lanes for infantry breakthrough.
SAC Counter-Drone Response	High-altitude Chinese-supplied CH-4 and Rainbow reconnaissance-strike UAVs; portable Russian/Chinese RF backpack directional jammers.	Constrained by resistance frequency-hopping protocols, foliage camouflage, and vulnerability of SAC jammers to direct FPV kinetic strikes.

PILLAR 3: STRATEGIC FACTIONAL ALIGNMENTS

Slide 9: EAO-SAC Strategic Relationships: 4-Tier Posture Taxonomy

TIER & POSTURE	ACTORS & ESTIMATED MANPOWER	STRATEGIC DOCTRINE & ENGAGEMENT WITH SAC
TIER 1 Total War & Active Eradication	- Three Brotherhood Alliance (AA, TNLA, MNDAA) - K7 Revolutionary Coalition (KIA, KNU, KNDF, CNF, NUG/PDF) Total: >140,000 active combatants	Irreconcilable military hostility. Systematically dismantling junta Regional Military Commands (Northeast Command fallen; Western Command besieged). Demands complete abolition of military dictatorship and realization of federal democracy.
TIER 2 Armed Neutrality & Autonomy	- United Wa State Army (UWSA - ~30,000) - NDAA (Mong La Special Region 4 - ~4,500) - Shan State Progress Party (SSPP - ~8,000) Total: >42,000 active combatants	Pragmatic non-aggression with SAC ground troops while serving as the primary arms and ammunition broker for northern resistance forces. Assumed administrative control of Hopang and Panlong peacefully in 2024.
TIER 3 Fractured Ceasefire Signatories	- Restoration Council of Shan State (RCSS) - NMSP vs. NMSP-AD (Mon State) - PNLO vs. PNLA (Pa-O / Shan South)	Severe generational and operational schisms. Frontline battalions (NMSP-AD, PNLA) broke the Nationwide Ceasefire Agreement (NCA) to launch joint combat against SAC alongside PDFs, while aging political councils retain contact with Naypyidaw.
TIER 4 Border Guard Forces & Proxies	- Pa-O National Army (PNO) - Shanni Nationalities Army (SNA) - Zomi Revolutionary Army (ZRA) - Karen BGF / KNA (Saw Chit Thu)	Local militia survival and illicit revenue preservation. PNO and SNA actively fight anti-junta resistance forces to defend regional garrison approaches. Karen BGF rebranded to KNA and declared tactical neutrality to protect border casino scam compounds.

PILLAR 4: STRATEGIC OUTLOOK & EARLY-WARNING

Slide 10: Strategic Force Balance & Civilian Early-Warning Advisory

STRATEGIC DOMAIN	CURRENT TRAJECTORY (MID-TO-LATE 2026)	OPERATIONAL DIRECTIVE & RECOMMENDATIONS
SAC Attrition Spiral	Over 40,000+ casualties, surrenders, and desertions. Enforcement of forced conscription has generated mass evasion and surrendered recruit battalions.	SAC ground combat power is irreversibly exhausted. Anticipate accelerated garrison collapses across Ann, Sittwe, and southern Shan approaches.
Logistical Collapse	Loss of overland border customs and mineral basins has severed foreign currency streams. Inability to purchase foreign aviation fuel or CNC machine tooling.	Air sortie rates will face severe degradation by late 2026 due to engine fatigue, airframe micro-cracking, and spare parts depletion.
Acoustic Early Warning	Parla acoustic edge sensors detect turbofan engine roar (40–120 Hz) and helicopter rotor slap (18.5–23.0 Hz) at ranges up to 15 km.	Pre-position autonomous listening nodes around central markets, schools, and hospitals to trigger 4 to 8-minute siren alarms before munition impact.
Zero-Trace Accountability	All strike dispatches, tail numbers, and munitions types are sanitized of source PII and fuzzed to 0.1° sector hashes.	Commit verified records atomically into the offline Merkle ledger (SHA-256) to establish evidentiary archives for international war-crimes tribunals.

Concluding Operations Research Assessment: The Myanmar civil war has passed the threshold of central state preservation. The future governance of Myanmar will not be dictated by Naypyidaw, but by negotiated confederated accords between ethnic revolutionary authorities and federal democratic resistance coalitions.